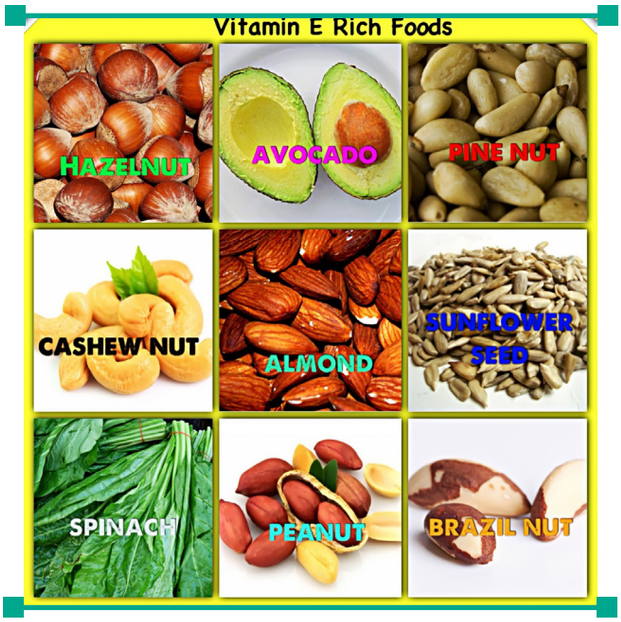
- **Food sources:** Vegetable oils, nuts and whole grams are the richest sources of vitamin E (eg. Wheat germ oil). It is present in small quantities in lettuce, grasses and embryos of many seeds. In general, plant foods are richer sources of vitamin E than animal foods.



- **Deficiency:** Vitamin E deficiency has been associated with irritability, edema and hemolytic anemia among infants. Also muscular dystrophy is common to all species in which there is degeneration of skeletal and cardiac muscle with vitamin E deficiency.

(d) Vitamin K

Vitamin K occurs in two forms.

1. Phylloquinones (vitamin K1) - plant source and dietary form of vitamin K
2. Menaquinone (vitamin K2) - synthesized by intestinal bacterial flora.

- **Functions:** The major functions of Vitamin K though not many are listed as follows:
  - Vitamin K is essential for blood clotting.
  - Required for the synthesis of blood clotting factors by the liver.
  - Vitamin K is vital to maintain normal levels and activation of blood clotting factor like prothrombin,
- **Food Sources:**
  The major dietary source of vitamin K is Phyllo Quinone which is present in high concentration in most vegetables like cabbage, spinach and cauliflower. Animal food sources include cheese, egg yolk, and liver.



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